

PIT at CLE · Thursday 2026-10-01 20:15 ET · Week 4 2026

League-wide only. Window: weeks 4–9, 2015–2025. $n \geq 10$. No team streaks. No half-EPA. Lines from nflverse games.csv (snapshot Oct 1). Scores and team-week stats through Week 3; EPA from play-by-play.

Line: PIT -2.5 / CLE +2.5, total 38.5. Trip: PIT → CLE 106 mi, 0 time zones. Rest: PIT 4 days, CLE 4 days. Roof: outdoors.

1. Season boxes

Wk	Team	Spot	Score	Line	ATS	Off yds	Rush	Pass EPA	Off EPA	Def EPA allowed	SR	TO
1	PIT	H vs ATL	20–13	-6.5	cover	279	58	-9.7	-16.3	-21.5	0.34	1
2	PIT	A at NE	3–20	+4.5	miss	278	91	-21.8	-22.2	-1.9	0.39	2
3	PIT	H vs CIN	30–27	+3.5	cover	430	138	+8.5	+11.3	+14.8	0.49	1
1	CLE	A at JAX	10–34	+8.5	miss	292	87	-5.6	-10.5	+16.7	0.43	2
2	CLE	A at TB	23–19	+8.5	cover	282	44	+10.4	+1.0	-13.0	0.45	0
3	CLE	H vs CAR	21–18	+2.5	cover	276	132	+2.1	+0.2	-7.7	0.38	1

Last game EPA (PBP): PIT off +11.3, def allowed +14.8, net -3.6, SR 0.49. CLE off +0.2, def allowed -7.7, net +7.9, SR 0.38. Records: PIT 2–1, CLE 2–1. ATS: PIT 2–1, CLE 2–1.

2. Lookahead and rest

- PIT: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, home, won by 3). 4 days rest. Week 5: home vs IND, non-division, Sunday early window.
- CLE: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, home, won by 3). 4 days rest. Week 5: road vs NYJ, non-division, Sunday early window.

3. What does not apply

- 2+ time-zone trip: no
- double-digit dog: no
- off a 10-point loss: no
- off a 20-point win: no
- 2nd straight home game: applies to CLE
- 2nd straight road game: no
- bye next week: no
- off a bye: no
- scored ≤ 10 last: no
- short week: applies to CLE, PIT
- trip ≥ 1000 mi: no
- TO ≥ 3 last: no
- undefeated entering: no
- winless entering: no

4. Stack, without double-counting

Header per chair is the walk-forward record: traits picked by max parent-minus-child gap on seasons before N at $n \geq 10$, printed on season N, N = 2019–2025, pooled. Every printed game is out of sample. The full-window stack (picked on all seasons at $n \geq 20$) and its diagnostics sit in the block below it. Same gate on every slot.

Both chairs resolve to the same games (mirror). Printed once; PIT's record is the complement.

- **CLE +2.5** — one population: Thursday night dog +1 to +3; outdoors. Not added (no gap with $n \geq 20$ left): short week (≤ 5 days rest), equal rest, host of a short-trip visitor (< 200 mi), off a win, off a 1-score win, off a cover, off an upset win as dog, off a home game....
- **Walk-forward 2–6 (25.0%, n=8)** — picked on seasons before N, printed on N, 2019–25. By year: 19:1-1 20:0-0 21:0-1 22:0-1 23:0-1 24:1-1 25:0-1. OOS cover margin median -5.2, $P(>+7)$ 0.12, $P(<-7)$ 0.38. Traits picked in ≥ 4 of 7 folds: Thursday night home dog +1 to +3 (4/7).
- Full-window stack (picked on all seasons): Thursday night dog +1 to +3; outdoors. ATS 9–10–1 (47.4%, n=20).
- By season: 15:0-0 16:1-1 17:3-1 18:1-1 19:1-1 20:2-0 21:0-2 22:1-2 23:0-1 24:0-1
- Cover margin: median -0.5, q25/q75 -7.6/+8.4; $P(>+7)$ 0.30, $P(<-7)$ 0.25
- Parent minus child: without 'outdoors': 12–15–1 (44.4%, n=28), the games it removed: 3–5 (37.5%, n=8)
- Anchor alone 12–15–1 (44.4%, n=28); anchor minus stack 3–5 (37.5%, n=8)
- Stack by line bucket: +1 to +3 9–10–1 (47.4%, n=20)

- Contrary cross: success rate $\leq .40$ last: 3–7 (30.0%, n=10) → in stack 3–4 (42.9%, n=7) | off a cover: 4–7–1 (36.4%, n=12) → in stack 3–5–1 (37.5%, n=9) | off a win: 4–6–1 (40.0%, n=11) → in stack 2–5–1 (28.6%, n=8) | equal rest: 12–15–1 (44.4%, n=28) → in stack 9–10–1 (47.4%, n=20)
- **PIT –2.5** — mirror of the above: walk-forward 10–9–1 (52.6%, n=20).
- **Total 38.5** — tightest full-window cut clearing n = 20: division game, total ≤ 42 — O–U 21–36 (36.8%, n=57).
- By season (O–U): 15:2-3 16:1-2 17:4-7 18:1-3 19:0-2 20:2-0 21:0-1 22:3-5 23:1-6 24:6-5 25:1-2
- Total margin (points – line): median -5.0, q25/q75 -9.5/+5.5; P(>+7) 0.18, P(<-7) 0.37
- **Walk-forward 19–16 in the training cut's direction (54.3%, n=35; raw O–U 16–19)** — cut chosen on seasons before N, printed on N; O/U after each year is the direction the training cut pointed. By year: 19:5-5U 20:2-0U 21:3-2U 22:3-5U 23:2-6U 24:1-1U 25:0-0U. OOS total margin median -2.5. Cuts picked: home dog, total ≤ 42 (2/7), division game, home dog, total ≤ 40 (2/7), division game, home dog (1/7), division game, total ≤ 42 (1/7), line within 3, total ≤ 39 (1/7).
- By total band: ≤ 39 2–9 (n=11); 40–44 19–24 (n=43)

Appendix A. Sides — CLE +2.5

CLE (home dog)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
home dog	168–169–8	49.9%	345
Thursday night home dog	13–15–1	46.4%	29
division home dog	56–53–2	51.4%	111
home dog +1 to +3	75–90–7	45.5%	172
division home dog +1 to +3	26–32–1	44.8%	59
Thursday night division home dog	8–9–1	47.1%	18
Thursday night dog +1 to +3	12–15–1	44.4%	28
Thursday night home dog +1 to +3	6–8–1	42.9%	15

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
scored ≤ 21 last, Thursday night	36–20–1	64.3%	57
TO ≤ 1 last, division home dog +1 to +3	11–23–1	32.4%	35
off an upset win as dog, Thursday night	4–11–1	26.7%	16
off yards ≤ 300 last, division home dog +1 to +3	5–12–1	29.4%	18
opponent off a cover, Thursday night	30–19–1	61.2%	50
off a cover, Thursday night	19–30–1	38.8%	50
TO ≤ 1 last, Thursday night division home dog	3–8–1	27.3%	12
off an upset win as dog, division home dog +1 to +3	8–3–1	72.7%	12
off a home game, home dog +1 to +3	18–28–1	39.1%	47
TO ≤ 1 last, home dog +1 to +3	41–55–2	42.7%	98
scored ≤ 21 last, Thursday night home dog	12–6–1	66.7%	19
equal rest, division home dog	38–27–2	58.5%	67
success rate $\leq .40$ last, Thursday night dog +1 to +3	3–7	30.0%	10
both off a win, division home dog	11–6	64.7%	17
scored ≤ 21 last, home dog	109–92–7	54.2%	208
TO ≤ 1 last, Thursday night	33–43–2	43.4%	78
off a win, Thursday night	22–30–1	42.3%	53
opponent off a win, Thursday night	30–22–1	57.7%	53
scored ≤ 21 last, division home dog	40–31–2	56.3%	73
off yards ≤ 300 last, home dog +1 to +3	19–26–3	42.2%	48
def EPA allowed ≤ -5 last, division home dog	14–9–1	60.9%	24
allowed ≤ 21 last, home dog	65–54–5	54.6%	124
off a win, Thursday night home dog	3–6–1	33.3%	10
TO ≤ 1 last, Thursday night home dog	7–11–1	38.9%	19

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
allowed ≤21 last, division home dog	24–18–2	57.1%	44
outdoors, home dog +1 to +3	54–64–7	45.8%	125
off a cover, Thursday night dog +1 to +3	4–7–1	36.4%	12
opponent off a win, Thursday night home dog	7–4	63.6%	11

Appendix B. Sides — PIT –2.5

Mirror of the chair above. Same games, other side.

PIT (road favorite)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
road favorite	169–168–8	50.1%	345
Thursday night road favorite	15–13–1	53.6%	29
division road favorite	53–56–2	48.6%	111
road fav –1 to –3	90–75–7	54.5%	172
division road fav –1 to –3	32–26–1	55.2%	59
Thursday night division road favorite	9–8–1	52.9%	18
Thursday night fav –1 to –3	15–12–1	55.6%	28
Thursday night road fav –1 to –3	8–6–1	57.1%	15

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
def EPA allowed ≥ +10 last, road favorite	51–30–1	63.0%	82
def EPA allowed ≥ +10 last, road fav –1 to –3	29–14–1	67.4%	44
next game is home non-division, road fav –1 to –3	54–33–5	62.1%	92
off yards ≥400 last, Thursday night	12–24	33.3%	36
off an upset win as dog, Thursday night	4–11–1	26.7%	16
next game is home, road fav –1 to –3	66–48–6	57.9%	120
off a cover, Thursday night	19–30–1	38.8%	50
opponent off a cover, Thursday night	30–19–1	61.2%	50
allowed ≥27 last, road fav –1 to –3	33–22–3	60.0%	58
allowed ≥27 last, road favorite	61–46–3	57.0%	110
off a home game, Thursday night fav –1 to –3	12–6–1	66.7%	19
off yards ≥400 last, road fav –1 to –3	37–26–2	58.7%	65
equal rest, division road favorite	27–38–2	41.5%	67
allowed ≥27 last, division road fav –1 to –3	13–7–1	65.0%	21
0 time zones, road fav –1 to –3	37–27–3	57.8%	67
next game is home non-division, road favorite	95–79–5	54.6%	179
both off a win, division road favorite	6–11	35.3%	17
def EPA allowed ≥ +10 last, division road fav –1 to –3	8–4	66.7%	12
TO ≤1 last, Thursday night	33–43–2	43.4%	78
scored 27–33 last, Thursday night	11–17	39.3%	28
off a win, Thursday night	22–30–1	42.3%	53
opponent off a win, Thursday night	30–22–1	57.7%	53
off a home game, division road fav –1 to –3	24–17–1	58.5%	42
off a home game, road fav –1 to –3	61–50–4	55.0%	115
0 time zones, division road fav –1 to –3	20–14–1	58.8%	35
next game is home non-division, division road fav –1 to –3	21–15	58.3%	36
opponent off a win, Thursday night road favorite	6–3–1	66.7%	10

Cut	ATS	Pct	n
next game is home non-division, division road favorite	38–30	55.9%	68

Appendix C. Total 38.5 — n ≥ 10 cuts

Cut	Over–Under	Over pct	n
division game, home dog, total ≤40	2–12	14.3%	14
division game, total ≤39	2–9	18.2%	11
division game, total ≤42	21–36	36.8%	57
division game, total ≤40	6–15	28.6%	21
division game, outdoors, total ≤39	2–8	20.0%	10
home dog, line within 3, total ≤39	4–11	26.7%	15
line within 3, visitor <200 mi	4–10–1	28.6%	15
line within 3, total ≤39	9–17	34.6%	26
division game, outdoors, total ≤40	5–11	31.2%	16
division game, line within 3, total ≤40	4–9	30.8%	13
line within 3, short week for a team	17–10–1	63.0%	28
outdoors, home dog, total ≤39	7–13–1	35.0%	21
outdoors, line within 3, total ≤39	8–14	36.4%	22
outdoors, total ≤39	17–25–1	40.5%	43
home dog, total ≤39	9–15–1	37.5%	25
division game, line within 3	54–65–3	45.4%	122
total ≤39	21–28–1	42.9%	50
outdoors, home dog	122–138–2	46.9%	262
line within 3, total ≤42	44–53	45.4%	97
short week for a team	36–29–1	55.4%	66
outdoors, total ≤42	86–75–1	53.4%	162
division game, home dog	50–59–2	45.9%	111

Feeds: nflverse games.csv (lines, scores, rest), stats_team_week 2015–2026 (yards, pass EPA, TO), play_by_play 2015–2026 (off/def EPA, success rate), data/airports.csv (miles, zones).